

was used at one time to help people put their boots on. Bootstrapping has passed into general usage from there and refers to the process of using something small to start something much bigger. Which is exactly what happens with a computer when it is switched on. When the computer is switched on, a small computer program will run a basic test on all the essential hardware to ensure that it is responding correctly, wake up the motherboard and hard disk and call the system files of the operating system as part of the boot process. The operating system will then take over from the boot file and load all the required system files and driver software for the hardware. Once all the required files are loaded through this process, known as the boot process, the operating system is ready for use.

6.2.5 Closed Source

A closed source system is one in which the source code cannot be accessed without the express permission of the owner of the software product. Much of the software these days is closed source and software companies charge a license fee for using their program. As compared to open source software, the license to the end user only permits usage of the software product and does not allow them to reverse engineer the product or derive the source code for the product.

6.2.6 Directory

Also known as a folder in Windows, a directory can contain other directories or files. Directories are used to help in organising the files on your computer so that it is easily remembered for later access. The structure of a directory is like a tree and as you move up the tree you will finally reach the root directory of the drive. The root directory will contain many directories, usually grouped according to functions. Some directories are created by the system and any modifications to the directory or its contents should be handled with extreme care. Other directories are created by application software where files necessary to its smooth operation are stored.